

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst, Defensive Operations | Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in Defensive Operations (DefOps), specialising in advanced threat detection, threat hunting, detection engineering, and incident response. I have strong hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), and I am experienced in conducting advanced investigations escalated from Managed Detection and Response (MDR) Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments, including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation. In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I develop and execute structured threat hunts informed by MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis and threat intelligence, converting findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations. I contribute to incident response playbook development, lead the full response lifecycle in line with NIST 800-61, and continuously improve detection coverage and operational tooling. I bring a highly analytical mindset, deep MITRE ATT&CK knowledge, and a genuine passion for Defensive Operations, and I am eager to contribute to a collaborative security team committed to proportionate and effective security controls.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, alert tuning, workbooks, incident management - Strong
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender - Strong; 8,000-user deployment
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response), Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, intelligence-led hunting; hunt-to-detection pipeline
- **Detection Engineering:** Writing and tuning detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; MITRE ATT&CK-mapped coverage analysis
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 full lifecycle; root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned
- **MDR / SOC Operations:** Advanced investigation of escalated alerts; tier escalation, case management, post-incident reporting
- **Playbook Development:** Incident response runbooks, SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) automation workflows
- **MITRE ATT&CK Framework:** Gap analysis, technique-mapped hunts, detection rule coverage mapping
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity Security:** Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL; automated SOAR playbook development
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Conduct advanced security investigations escalated from the MDR SOC and internally identified threats, including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across Microsoft Sentinel

and Defender XDR

- Lead incident response activities through the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle: detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; develop and maintain IR playbooks and operational procedures
- Develop and execute structured threat hunting exercises based on MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, threat intelligence feeds, and incident learnings; convert hunt findings into detection rules or tuning recommendations
- Engineer and tune detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, continuously improving detection fidelity and reducing alert fatigue across CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Sentinel
- Perform threat modelling on new services and infrastructure changes, embedding security controls and detection considerations into the change lifecycle
- Manage vulnerability remediation using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, using simulation data to validate detection coverage against real-world attack techniques
- Administer Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) and CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user enterprise environment
- Manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust, governing privileged account access and session monitoring
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation workflows to orchestrate response actions and reduce manual analyst workload
- Provide security guidance on infrastructure and change projects, ensuring security-by-design and proportionate control application

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, escalating significant threats to senior analysts with full case documentation
- Contributed to detection engineering by writing KQL detection queries and tuning alert thresholds in Microsoft Sentinel, improving signal quality across the SIEM
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, enhancing XDR coverage and identity threat detection
- Participated in MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat hunting exercises, identifying gaps in detection coverage and recommending new detection logic
- Assisted with incident response activities including containment, eradication, and post-incident reviews; contributed to playbook documentation
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking remediation and producing risk reports for stakeholders
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway policies, investigating phishing and Business Email Compromise (BEC) campaigns

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security operations for a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, managing endpoint protection and infrastructure security controls
- Administered network firewalls, security gateway configurations, and perimeter defence controls
- Assisted in vulnerability scanning, patch management, and remediation tracking
- Supported identity and access management processes and MFA configuration

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a structured threat hunting programme at UAL grounded in MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, establishing a repeatable hunt-to-detection pipeline that converted findings directly into new detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, materially improving XDR coverage and enabling identity-based threat detection across the enterprise

- Developed and automated SOAR playbooks to orchestrate containment and triage actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-frequency alert types
- Led Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises that validated detection controls against real attack techniques, directly informing the MITRE ATT&CK coverage roadmap
- Maintained UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification through continuous vulnerability management and proportionate security control assurance

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)